

What actually is financial wellbeing, and why should I care about mine?

Wellbeing, or wellness, is seen by many – especially those who are fond of expressions like ‘snowflake’ and ‘woke’ as insults, and view financial stability as a simple ‘in vs out’ equation – as a very current preoccupation. This makes sense in some ways – as the world has sped up, exposing us to more and more stressors, the need to focus on our own health and state of mind has increased. We need something to counterbalance the chaos of everyday life, the infinite channels of communication we are open to, and the wellness industry presents us with solutions that it claims will help us to achieve that elusive balance. But wellbeing runs much deeper than that, and psychologists and philosophers have been discussing and debating it for centuries, maybe even millennia. There is something fundamental about it, something that defies time and technology, but is rooted deeply inside of all of us. Wellbeing is, simply put, the business of feeling content and balanced in mind, body and soul, most of the time. It is not being in a constant good mood, but having the ability to cope well with life’s inevitable ups and downs, to have a genuine resilience that doesn’t rely on superficial things. For all of its simplicity in concept, it can be incredibly difficult in practice, and especially once you bring money into the equation.

One of those people spending their time mulling over what people need for general wellbeing was, perhaps, one of the most well-known psychologists in history: Abraham H.